

Marketing English

Participant workbook: strategy, messaging, briefs, SEO, paid media, lifecycle, analytics, compliance, and marketing dialogue practice

Audience: advanced ESL learners working in marketing, product marketing, growth, content, SEO, lifecycle, demand generation, social, agency, and related roles

Focus: high-level professional English for marketing workplaces, including customer insight, positioning, campaign briefs, content, SEO, paid media, lifecycle marketing, analytics, attribution, compliance, brand risk, and realistic marketing dialogue.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already work in marketing, product marketing, growth, content, brand, marketing operations, demand generation, social, agency, or marketing-adjacent roles.

Teaching stance: marketing English is persuasion under constraint. Learners need to be clear, creative, evidence-aware, compliance-aware, and commercially useful. This course teaches professional language and judgment, not a guarantee that a campaign, channel, claim, or tactic will work in every market.

How to Use This Workbook

This workbook helps you sound precise and useful in marketing conversations. The goal is not to use more buzzwords. The goal is to clarify audience, insight, message, channel, proof, measurement, and risk so that creative and commercial decisions can move forward.

Your starting point

- Which marketing conversations are hardest for you: briefs, creative reviews, analytics readouts, sales alignment, legal review, agency calls, or executive updates?
- Which marketing terms do you understand when reading but avoid when speaking?
- When someone asks for a campaign without enough context, do you become too agreeable, too technical, too indirect, or too blunt?
- What is one recent marketing meeting you wish you had handled more clearly?

Use the guided dialogue activities below. Every item has four choices and a rationale in the answer key; no open-ended writing is required.

Marketing Workstream Language

Area	Useful verbs	Example sentence
Strategy	segment, target, prioritize, position, validate	We need to validate the audience before choosing channels.
Messaging	frame, claim, substantiate, differentiate, simplify	The feature is useful, but the message should start with the buyer pain.
Campaigns	brief, launch, coordinate, sequence, localize	The campaign can launch only after creative, legal, and sales enablement are ready.
Channels	optimize, bid, rank, nurture, retarget	The channel is efficient for form fills but weak for qualified pipeline.
Analytics	attribute, compare, test, segment, reconcile	The platform data and CRM data answer different questions.
Risk	review, disclose, pause, escalate, approve	The claim needs substantiation before publication.

Practice Pages

Module 1. Marketing Strategy: Audience, Insight, Problem, Outcome

Marketing conversations often fail because the team jumps to tactics before agreeing on audience, problem, insight, desired behavior, and business outcome.

What you should be able to do

- Distinguish goal, audience, segment, ICP, persona, insight, problem, offer, and channel.
- Ask strategy questions that turn vague requests into usable briefs.
- Explain the difference between awareness, demand, pipeline, retention, and brand equity goals.

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A VP asks for a campaign but cannot define the target audience or business outcome.

Speaker	Line
VP	We need a big awareness campaign next month.
Marketing lead	Awareness among whom, and what should they do after seeing it?
ESL learner	Before we brief creative, we need to define the audience, insight, message, channel, budget, and measurement. Awareness for executives is different from awareness for end users.
VP	Just make noise in the market.
ESL learner	We can create visibility, but to spend responsibly we need a specific audience and a signal of success, such as branded search lift, site visits from target accounts, or sales _____.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	assumption
B	mitigation
C	conversations
D	timeline

Module 2. Positioning, Messaging, Brand Voice, and Proof

Strong marketing language says who the product is for, what problem it solves, why it is different, and what proof supports the claim. Weak marketing language only sounds positive.

What you should be able to do

- Use positioning and message architecture terms accurately.
- Write value propositions, proof points, CTAs, and objection-handling language.
- Distinguish brand voice from vague preference or personal taste.

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

Product wants the homepage headline to lead with a technical feature.

Speaker	Line
Product manager	The headline should say 'AI-powered orchestration layer.' That is the feature.
Content lead	Customers may not know why that matters.
ESL learner	Can we lead with the customer problem and use the feature as proof? The buyer cares about reducing manual handoffs and missed approvals. 'AI-powered orchestration' supports the claim, but it should not be the whole message.
Product manager	But competitors say similar things.
ESL learner	Then the proof matters even more: workflow examples, time saved, integration depth, and customer _____.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	control
B	disclosure
C	evidence
D	approval

Module 3. Campaign Briefs, GTM Planning, and Cross-Functional Alignment

Campaigns sit between strategy and execution. Learners need language for goals, target audience, offer, channel mix, timeline, assets, sales handoff, launch tier, dependencies, and decision rights.

What you should be able to do

- Write and discuss a campaign brief with enough detail for creative, channel, sales, and analytics teams.
- Run alignment conversations among product, sales, legal, customer success, and agency partners.
- Use tradeoff language when timeline, budget, quality, compliance, and scope conflict.

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

Marketing reports strong ad-platform ROAS, but sales says leads are poor.

Speaker	Line
Performance marketer	Google Ads shows a 5.2 ROAS. We should scale budget.
Sales director	The leads are not converting to qualified opportunities.
ESL learner	Platform ROAS is useful, but we need to reconcile it with CRM revenue, lead quality, and sales-cycle stage. Are these conversions high-intent demo requests or low-intent content downloads?
Performance marketer	Mostly webinar registrations.
ESL learner	Then I would not scale yet. Let's separate acquisition cost by conversion type and optimize toward qualified _____, not only form fills.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	pipeline
B	approval
C	control
D	disclosure

Module 4. Content, SEO, Thought Leadership, and Editorial Judgment

Content marketing is not filling a calendar. Good content connects audience intent, search behavior, expertise, brand credibility, distribution, and conversion path.

What you should be able to do

- Discuss SEO, content strategy, editorial calendars, keyword intent, internal linking, metadata, and content quality.
- Explain when a piece is meant to educate, rank, convert, nurture, or support sales.
- Push back on thin content, keyword stuffing, unsupported claims, and content that lacks a distribution plan.

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

The CFO questions whether marketing really created pipeline.

Speaker	Line
CFO	Sales says they sourced this opportunity. Marketing says it influenced it. Which is true?
Marketing ops	Both can be true under different attribution models.
ESL learner	Last-click attribution shows the final touch before conversion. Influenced pipeline shows that marketing touched the account during the buying journey. Neither model alone proves causality.
CFO	So what should I trust?
ESL learner	Trust the model for the question it can answer. For budget decisions, we should combine attribution, incrementality tests, sales feedback, and pipeline _____.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	risk
B	owner
C	quality
D	evidence

Module 5. Paid Media, Performance Marketing, and Attribution

Performance marketing requires disciplined language around targeting, bidding, budget, CPA, CAC, ROAS, incrementality, attribution windows, landing-page quality, and diminishing returns.

What you should be able to do

- Use paid media metrics and channel terms accurately.
- Explain why platform-reported conversions may not equal business impact.
- Discuss budget shifts, testing, audience saturation, creative fatigue, and incrementality.

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A senior stakeholder dislikes a social ad concept because it does not match their personal taste.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	I do not like this. It feels too informal.
Designer	The brief asked for approachable and direct.
ESL learner	Can we evaluate it against the brief? The target audience is first-time managers, the objective is webinar registration, and the tone is meant to reduce intimidation. The question is whether this creative makes the next step feel accessible.
Stakeholder	But our brand is premium.
ESL learner	Agreed. We can preserve premium through layout and proof, while keeping the language human enough for the _____.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	approval
B	control
C	audience
D	mitigation

Module 6. Lifecycle, CRM, Email, Marketing Ops, and Sales Handoff

Lifecycle marketing depends on definitions and trust. Marketing and sales must agree on lead stages, qualification criteria, nurture logic, consent, deliverability, handoff, and feedback loops.

What you should be able to do

- Use lifecycle terms such as lead, MQL, SQL, nurture, segmentation, suppression, deliverability, and UTM accurately.
- Discuss email metrics with caveats, including open-rate limitations and click-quality questions.
- Negotiate MQL criteria and sales follow-up expectations without turning the meeting into blame.

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

Sales rejects many leads that marketing counts as MQLs.

Speaker	Line
Sales manager	These MQLs are not ready. They downloaded one guide and never replied.
Demand gen	They meet the scoring threshold.
ESL learner	Then the score may be overweighting engagement and underweighting fit or buying intent. We should define MQL as fit plus behavior, and create a recycle path for leads that are interested but not sales-ready.
Sales manager	What changes?
ESL learner	Add firmographic fit, require stronger intent for handoff, and create feedback reasons when sales _____ a lead.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	timeline
B	assumption
C	rejects
D	scope

Module 7. Analytics, Experimentation, Funnel Reporting, and Executive Readouts

Marketing analytics is not only reporting numbers. Learners must explain source, definition, confidence, attribution, sample size, funnel movement, and what the business should do next.

What you should be able to do

- Discuss dashboards, KPIs, funnel conversion, cohort analysis, A/B tests, lift, sample size, and statistical caution.
- Separate vanity metrics from decision metrics.
- Present executive readouts that connect activity, learning, pipeline, revenue, and next action.

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A content article uses a bold claim that legal says is unsupported.

Speaker	Line
SEO manager	This headline will rank and convert.
Legal	The claim 'cuts costs in half' needs substantiation.
ESL learner	Can we keep the search intent but adjust the claim? For example, 'ways to reduce support costs' is safer than promising a specific result unless we have evidence that result is typical.
SEO manager	Will that weaken the headline?
ESL learner	Maybe, but an unsupported claim creates regulatory and trust _____. We can strengthen the article with a case study, methodology, and clearer qualifiers.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	owner
B	scope
C	risk
D	evidence

Module 8. Compliance, Privacy, Claims, Influencers, Brand Safety, and Crisis Response

Marketing teams need persuasive language that stays truthful, substantiated, permission-aware, and brand-safe. Under pressure, the best marketers can protect both growth and trust.

What you should be able to do

- Use compliance language for claim substantiation, endorsements, disclosures, consent, opt-out, privacy, and brand safety.
- Push back on risky copy, dark patterns, undisclosed incentives, fake urgency, and unsupported testimonials.
- Respond to social backlash or reputational risk with calm, approved, audience-aware language.

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

Lifecycle marketing reviews an email campaign with a high open rate but low revenue impact.

Speaker	Line
Lifecycle marketer	Open rate increased by 12 percent after the new subject line.
VP Marketing	Did it produce more revenue?
ESL learner	Open rate is a weak success metric by itself, especially with privacy-related measurement noise. Click rate, conversion, unsubscribe rate, and downstream revenue tell us more about intent.
Lifecycle marketer	So was the test a failure?
ESL learner	Not necessarily. The subject line improved attention, but the offer or landing page may not have moved people to _____.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	assumption
B	mitigation
C	action
D	timeline

Phrase Bank

Strategy and brief clarification

- Who exactly is the audience, and what behavior do we want to change?
- Is the goal awareness, demand capture, pipeline, retention, or brand trust?
- What customer insight is the campaign built on?
- Before we brief creative, we need the audience, message, offer, channel, budget, and measurement plan.

Positioning and creative feedback

- Can we lead with the customer problem and use the feature as proof?
- The claim is clear, but the proof is not strong enough yet.
- Let's evaluate the creative against the brief, not personal taste.
- The tone can be more human without losing premium brand cues.

Paid media and attribution

- Platform ROAS is useful, but we need to reconcile it with CRM revenue and lead quality.
- Last-click attribution answers a different question from influenced pipeline.
- This metric shows activity, not necessarily incrementality.
- Before scaling spend, we should diagnose audience saturation, creative fatigue, and landing-page conversion.

Lifecycle and sales alignment

- The MQL definition should include both fit and intent.
- A rejected lead should create a feedback reason, not only a disagreement.
- Open rate improved, but click rate and downstream conversion tell us more about intent.
- This nurture path may be too sales-heavy for leads still in the education stage.

Analytics and testing

- The result is directionally promising, but not conclusive.
- We should define the hypothesis, sample size, decision rule, and risk before launch.
- That is a vanity metric unless it changes a budget, message, or channel decision.
- The dashboard should separate leading indicators from business outcomes.

Compliance and brand safety

- We need substantiation before making that claim.
- If there is a material connection, the disclosure needs to be clear.
- The copy creates urgency, but it may overstate scarcity.
- Let's pause scheduled promotion while we confirm facts and align on the response.

Answer Key and Rationale

Check each answer after completing the dialogue. The rationale shows why the correct phrase is the strongest fit for the real workplace situation.

1. Campaign Brief: 'We Need Awareness'

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. conversations	'conversations' is the precise phrase used in this professional response. The other choices do not fit the dialogue's meaning or grammar.

2. Positioning Debate: Product Feature vs Customer Problem

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. evidence	'evidence' is the precise phrase used in this professional response. The other choices do not fit the dialogue's meaning or grammar.

3. Paid Search: ROAS Looks Good, Sales Quality Is Weak

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. pipeline	'pipeline' is the precise phrase used in this professional response. The other choices do not fit the dialogue's meaning or grammar.

4. Attribution Fight: Last Click vs Influenced Pipeline

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. quality	'quality' is the precise phrase used in this professional response. The other choices do not fit the dialogue's meaning or grammar.

5. Creative Review: Taste vs Brief

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. audience	'audience' is the precise phrase used in this professional response. The other choices do not fit the dialogue's meaning or grammar.

6. MQL Definition: Marketing and Sales Disagree

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. rejects	'rejects' is the precise phrase used in this professional response. The other choices do not fit the dialogue's meaning or grammar.

7. SEO and Legal Review: Claim Too Strong

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. risk	'risk' is the precise phrase used in this professional response. The other choices do not fit the dialogue's meaning or grammar.

8. Email Readout: Open Rate Is Up, Revenue Is Flat

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. action	'action' is the precise phrase used in this professional response. The other choices do not fit the dialogue's meaning or grammar.